

Government approves norms to set up charging infrastructure for EVs

The government has approved amendments to Model Building By-laws (MBBL), 2016, and Urban Regional Development Plans Formulation and Implementation (URDPFI) Guidelines, 2014, to set up charging stations for electric vehicles (EVs) across the country. A spokesperson for Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs said that the guidelines will act as a guiding document for the state governments and union territories to incorporate the norms and standards of EV charging infrastructure in their respective building by-laws.

Government mulling interoperability for public Wi-Fi networks

Telecom secretary Aruna Sundararajan has said that the government is considering a proposal to enable interoperability for public Wi-Fi networks, which will translate into a seamless connectivity experience for users. While speaking at De-licensing of 5GHz for Public Wi-Fi event organised by Broadband India Forum, she also said that 370,000 Wi-Fi hotspots have been deployed by the industry as against the stated commitment of rolling out one million Wi-Fi hotspots by December 2019.

Over 150 mobile manufacturing units set up in India in four years

With the government's Make in India push, the country witnessed the setting up of more than 150 mobile handset manufacturing units in the past four years, according to a report from CyberMedia Research (CMR). At the end of Q4 2018, completely knocked down manufacturing stood at 57 per cent, while semi knocked down manufacturing stood at around 39 per cent, according

to CMR's India Mobile Handset Market Review Report for 2018. The share of completely built units was four per cent, the findings showed.

BEL CMD wins Business Leader of the Year award

Gowtama M.V., chairman and managing director, Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL), has been conferred with Business Leader of the Year award at Aerospace & Defence Awards (2019) organised by International Aerospace media group at Bengaluru.

PGCIL gets nod to offer power towers to telecom firms

State-owned power transmission firm Power Grid Corp. of India (PGCIL) can now offer its electricity towers to telecom operators. Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC) has given approval on the same to address the issue of deficiency of telecom coverage in remote areas. *Financial Express* reported that PGCIL will bear the capital expenditure for infrastructure changes that would be required to add the telecom setup (about ₹ 2 million per location), and the money will be recovered from telecom operators.

Oppo, Vivo likely to make key parts locally

Cellphone makers Oppo and Vivo are likely to follow their South Korean rival Samsung in making key components locally in the next one year, sources told *Business Standard*. The move comes as the Centre deferred the imposition of duties on crucial parts. According to recent reports, Samsung will begin making components from April 2020, once the duty kicks in. Production will start at its Noida facility, which is also its largest cellphone manufacturing plant in the world.

order bagged by BHEL till now.

BHEL will be setting up the plants on an EPC basis at four locations in the state. These include a 50MW plant at Ramagundam in Peddapalli district, a 39MW plant at Yellandu, a 30MW plant at Manuguru in Bhadrachalam district and a 10MW plant at Pegadapally in Jagtial district. With this order, the solar portfolio of BHEL has increased to over 710MW.

Suzuki Motors road tests 50 EVs in India

Focusing on the Indian electric vehicles (EVs) market, Japanese automotive

maker Suzuki Motors has announced that the company is road testing 50 of its EVs in the country. Toshihiro Suzuki, president, Suzuki Motors Corp., said that the company is exploring EVs as well as hybrid options for the Indian market, keeping the focus on the reduction of pollution.

The company is also setting up a plant for manufacturing automobile lithium-ion batteries in Hansalpur, Ahmedabad, along with localising other components that are needed for EVs. The company is also planning to commission a third assembly plant by 2020.

Budget 2019: LED bulbs led to annual savings of ₹ 500 billion in electricity bills

UJALA scheme that provides LED bulbs to all households across the country has resulted in annual savings of up to ₹ 500 billion in electricity bills, for the poor and middle-class families, said Finance Minister Piyush Goyal in his Interim Budget speech for 2019-20. He also said that the government, with the participation of the private sector, has provided 1.43 billion LED bulbs in the country so far.

UJALA scheme was launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in January 2015, and is currently the largest LED distribution programme in the world. It is a zero-subsidy scheme that aims to promote efficient lighting, enhance awareness about energy-efficient equipment that reduce electricity bills and contribute to the energy security of India.

Notably, India's share in the global LED market has increased to 12 per cent from a mere 0.1 per cent, with the penetration of LEDs in the domestic market alone rising to 10 per cent from 0.4 per cent.

Government may scrap duty on open-cell LED panels to boost Make in India

The government is likely to scrap the duty on open-cell LED panels—a critical TV component. This is because duty-free imports from ASEAN countries are becoming more attractive than manufacturing TVs locally, which is impacting Make in India initiative, reported *Economic Times*.

As per the report, Samsung Electronics has stopped making TVs in India, and is now importing these from ASEAN countries, while LG Electronics is considering following suit. A senior official of Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has said the government is contemplating removing the five per cent duty since it is hampering the efforts to encourage manufacturing in India. Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion is backing the move, and a final decision will be taken in consultation with the finance ministry, the official said.